

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF BRONX-----X
Deuri Carambot, :: Index Number:
Date Purchased:
: Date Filed:

Plaintiffs : SUMMONS

-against- :

City of New York, New York City Police Department, :
Police Officer Jonathan Keith, Shield 19375 of the 46 :
Precinct, Sergeant Sandy Espinal, Shield 2323 of the 46 :
Precinct and New York City Police Officers John Doe, :
:: Plaintiff's residence is:
2396 Morris Avenue
: Bronx, NY 10468

Defendants

-----X

TO THE ABOVE NAMED DEFENDANTS:

YOU ARE HEREBY SUMMONED to Answer the Verified Complaint in this action and serve a copy of your answer, or if the Verified Complaint is not served with this Summons to serve a notice of Appearance on the Plaintiffs attorney within twenty (20) days after the service of this Summons, exclusive of the day of service (or within thirty (30) days after the service is complete if this Summons is not personally delivered to you within the State of New York) and in case of your failure to appear or answer, judgment will be taken against you by default for the relief demanded in the Verified Complaint.

The basis of venue designated is that the cause of action arose in Bronx County.

Dated: January 11, 2022
Bronx, NY

Yours, etc.,

Jason Steinberger

LAW OFFICES OF JASON A. STEINBERGER, LLC
Attorney for Plaintiffs
505 Eighth Avenue, Suite 1H
New York, NY 10018
(646) 256-1007

To: City of New York

New York City Police Department

Police Officer Jonathan Keith, Shield 19375 of the 46 Precinct

Sergeant Sandy Espinal, Shield 2323 of the 46 Precinct

New York City Police Officers John Doe

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF BRONX

-----X	:	
Deuri Carambot,	:	
	:	
Plaintiffs	:	VERIFIED COMPLAINT
	:	
-against-	:	
	:	
City of New York, New York City Police Department,	:	
Police Officer Jonathan Keith, Shield 19375 of the 46	:	
Precinct, Sergeant Sandy Espinal, Shield 2323 of the 46	:	
Precinct and New York City Police Officers John Doe,	:	
	:	
Defendants	:	
-----X	:	

Plaintiff, by and through his attorney, JASON A. STEINBERGER, Esq, for his complaint,
alleges upon information and belief as follows:

STATEMENT OF FACTS

1. That at all times hereinafter mentioned, Plaintiff Deuri Carambot, (hereinafter referred to as “CARAMBOT”) resides in Bronx, State of New York.
2. That at all times hereinafter mentioned, Police Officer Jonathan Keith, Shield 19375 of the 46 Precinct (hereinafter referred to as “KEITH”) was employed by the New York City Police Department.
3. That at all times hereinafter mentioned, Police Officer Sandy Espinal, Shield 2323 of the 46 Precinct (hereinafter referred to as “ESPINAL”) was employed by the New York City Police Department.

4. That at all times hereinafter mentioned, the New York City Police Officer John Doe, involved in the arrest of Plaintiff (hereinafter referred to as “DOE”) were employed by the New York City Police Department.

5. That at all times hereinafter mentioned, Defendant City of New York, is a municipal corporation organized and existing under the laws of the State of New York, with a principal place of business located at 1 Centre Street, County of New York State of New York.

6. That at all times hereinafter mentioned, Defendant New York City Police Department, is an agency created and maintained by the above municipal government.

7. On or before about July 23, 2020 notice required by Municipal Law 50-E was given to City of New York, by personal service. Said notice set forth the facts underlying Plaintiffs’ claim against the City of New York, and its agents and employees. To date, no answer has been received by Plaintiff and no compensation has been offered by the City of New York.

8. That on or about July 14, 2020 at approximately 9:00 PM in the vicinity of 2396 Morris Avenue, Bronx, NY Plaintiff was stopped, handcuffed and arrested by KEITH, ESPINAL and DOES.

9. That at no time did Plaintiff sell a controlled substance to any anyone.

10. That at no time did Plaintiff possess or exercise custody and control over a controlled substance.

11. That at no time did Plaintiff possess or exercise custody and control over marijuana.

12. That at no time was Plaintiff involved in any unlawful or illegal behavior.

13. That after Plaintiff was unlawfully arrested, he was transported to the 46 precinct.

14. That after Plaintiff arrived at the 46 precinct he was placed into a cell with other male prisoners.

15. That while at the 46 precinct Plaintiff was ordered to strip his clothes off for the purposes of a search.

16. That at no time was anything illegal or unlawful was recovered during the strip search.

17. That after spending several hours at the 46 precinct, Plaintiff was removed to Bronx County Central Booking located at 215 East 161 Street, Bronx, NY 10451.

18. That on or about July 16, 2020 Plaintiff was arraigned in Bronx County Criminal Court, charging him with Criminal Sale of a Controlled Substance in the Third Degree and related offenses.

19. That at the time of his arraignment, Plaintiff was released and ordered to return to court.

20. That on and between July 16, 2020 and October 6, 2021, Plaintiff made numerous court appearances until the case against Plaintiff was dismissed upon application of the Office of the Bronx District Attorney.

AS AND FOR A FIRST CAUSE OF ACTION AGAINST DEFENDANTS

21. Plaintiffs repeats, reiterates and realleges the allegations contained in paragraphs 1 through 20, as if more fully stated herein at length.

22. That Defendants acted with actual malice toward Plaintiff and with willful and wanton indifference to and deliberate disregard for the statutory and constitutional rights of the Plaintiff.

23. That the actions of the Defendants constituted unreasonable deprivation of liberty without due process of law.

24. That as a result of the actions by Defendants Plaintiff was traumatized and fears for his physical safety when he sees and encounters members of the New York City Police Department from that day and onward.

25. That as a result of the Defendants' actions, Plaintiff has been unable to sleep.

26. That as a result of the Defendants' actions, Plaintiff was forced to miss multiple days from work.

27. That as a result of the Defendants' actions Plaintiff sustained damage to his person in the sum within the jurisdiction of the Supreme Court and in excess of all inferior courts.

AS AND FOR A SECOND CAUSE OF ACTION AGAINST DEFENDANTS

28. Plaintiffs repeats, reiterates and realleges the allegations contained in paragraphs 1 through 27, as if more fully stated herein at length.

29. The intentional verbal abuse, false arrest, false imprisonment and maliciously prosecuted by Defendants violated the rights of Plaintiff as guaranteed by the Fourth, Fifth and Eighth Amendments to the United States Constitution, as well as the corresponding sections of the New York State Constitution, for which Defendants are individually liable.

30. Defendants having no lawful authority to arrest Plaintiff did, nevertheless, unlawfully arrest Plaintiff with actual malice toward her and with willful and wanton indifference to and deliberate disregard for his constitutional rights. Thus Plaintiff is entitled to both compensatory and exemplary damages.

AS AND FOR A THIRD CAUSE OF ACTION AS AGAINST DEFENDANTS

31. Plaintiffs repeats, reiterates and realleges the allegations contained in paragraphs 1 through 30, as if more fully stated herein at length.

32. Defendants conspired to violate Plaintiff's statutory civil rights in violation of 42 U.S.C. sec.1983, et al as well as the corresponding sections of the New York State Constitution, for

which Defendants are individually liable. Thus Plaintiff is entitled to both compensatory and exemplary damages, as well as attorney's fees.

AS AND FOR A FOURTH CAUSE OF ACTION AS AGAINST DEFENDANTS

33. Plaintiffs repeats, reiterates and realleges the allegations contained in paragraphs 1 through 32, as if more fully stated herein at length.

34. Plaintiff was verbally abused, falsely arrested, falsely imprisoned and maliciously prosecuted by Defendants in a manner that was extreme, outrageous and unjustified and caused Plaintiff to suffer physical and severe emotional distress for which the Defendants are individually liable. The verbal abuse, false arrest, false imprisonment and malicious prosecution on and of Plaintiff by Defendants were unjustified and done with actual malice and wanton indifference to and deliberate disregard for human life and the rights of Plaintiff. Plaintiff is thus entitled to compensatory and exemplary damages.

35. That during the pendency of the case KEITH, ESPINAL and DOES maliciously prosecuted Plaintiff by continuing to cooperate in a prosecution when Plaintiff should never have been arrested. Plaintiff is thus entitled to compensatory and exemplary damages.

36. That during the pendency of the case, KEITH, ESPINAL and DOES maliciously prosecuted Plaintiff by continuing to claim that he sold a controlled substance when he did not. Plaintiff is thus entitled to compensatory and exemplary damages.

37. That during the pendency of the case, KEITH, ESPINAL and DOES maliciously prosecuted Plaintiff by continuing to claim that he possessed a controlled substance when he did not. Plaintiff is thus entitled to compensatory and exemplary damages.

38. That during the pendency of the case, KEITH, ESPINAL and DOES maliciously prosecuted Plaintiff by continuing to claim that he possessed marijuana when he did not. Plaintiff is thus entitled to compensatory and exemplary damages.

**AS AND FOR A FIFTH CAUSE OF ACTION AS AGAINST CITY OF NEW YORK AND
NEW YORK CITY POLICE DEPARTMENT**

39. Plaintiffs repeats, reiterates and realleges the allegations contained in paragraphs 1 through 38, as if more fully stated herein at length.

40. At all times pertinent hereto, KEITH, ESPINAL and DOES were acting within the scope of their employment as officers of the New York City Police Department and City of New York.

41. The City of New York and New York City Police Department are each liable for compensatory damages under the doctrine of respondeat superior for the intentional torts that KEITH, ESPINAL and DOES committed were within the scope of their employment.

AS AND FOR A SIXTH CAUSE OF ACTION AS AGAINST DEFENDANTS

42. Plaintiffs repeats, reiterates and realleges the allegations contained in paragraphs 1 through 41, as if more fully stated herein at length.

43. The City of New York and New York City Police Department's failure to provide adequate training and supervision to its police officers constitutes a willful and wanton indifference and deliberate disregard for human life and the rights of private citizens, including Plaintiff. Plaintiff is thus entitled to compensatory exemplary damages.

AS AND FOR A SEVENTH CAUSE OF ACTION AS AGAINST DEFENDANTS

44. Plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges the allegations contained in paragraphs 1 through 43, as if more fully stated herein at length.

45. Upon information and belief, the City of New York and New York City Police Department maintained a system of review of police conduct which was so untimely and cursory that it was ineffective and permitted and tolerated the unreasonable detention of Plaintiff.

46. Upon information and belief, the City of New York and New York City Police Department maintained a system of review of police conduct which was so untimely and cursory that it was ineffective and permitted the wanton indifference to and deliberate disregard for the statutory and constitutional rights of Plaintiff.

47. That the City of New York and New York City Police Department was aware that there was at least one (1) Civilian Complaint Review Board complaint against KEITH for physical force. Despite such, the City of New York and New York City Police Department continued to employ him.

48. That the City of New York and New York City Police Department was aware that there was a civil rights case brought against KEITH on Curet v. City of New York et al, index number 025963/2018E. Despite such, the City of New York and New York City Police Department continued to employ him.

49. That the City of New York and New York City Police Department was aware that there was a civil rights case brought against KEITH on index number 025962/2018E, Curet v. City of New York et al, Supreme Court, Bronx County. Despite such, the City of New York and New York City Police Department continued to employ him.

50. That the City of New York and New York City Police Department was aware that there was a civil rights case brought against KEITH on index number 030634/2020E, Joe Corona v. City of New York et al, Supreme Court, Bronx County. Despite such, the City of New York and New York City Police Department continued to employ him.

51. That the City of New York and New York City Police Department was aware that there was at least nine (9) Civilian Complaint Review Board complaints against ESPINAL for unlawful stops and searches. Despite such, the City of New York and New York City Police Department continued to employ him.

WHEREFORE, Plaintiff demands judgment against the Defendants as follows:

On the first cause of action, a sum within the jurisdiction of this Court and in excess of all inferior courts;

On the second cause of action, a sum within the jurisdiction of the of this Court and in excess of all inferior courts, together with the additional exemplary sum within the jurisdiction of this court and in excess of all inferior courts owing to the willful and wanton nature of Defendants actions.

On the third cause of action, a sum within the jurisdiction of the of this Court and in excess of all inferior courts together with the additional exemplary sum within the jurisdiction of this court and in excess of all inferior courts owing to the willful and wanton nature of Defendants actions.

On the fourth cause of action, a sum within the jurisdiction of the of this Court and in excess of all inferior courts together with the additional exemplary sum within the jurisdiction of

this court and in excess of all inferior courts owing to the Defendants' wanton and willful actions;

On the fifth cause of action, a sum within the jurisdiction of the of this Court and in excess of all inferior courts

On the sixth cause of action, a sum within the jurisdiction of the of this Court and in excess of all inferior courts together with the additional exemplary sum within the jurisdiction of this court and in excess of all inferior courts.

On the seventh cause of action, a sum within the jurisdiction of this Court and in excess of all inferior courts.

Law Offices of Jason A. Steinberger, LLC

Jason Steinberger
Jason A. Steinberger, Esq.
Attorney for Plaintiff
505 Eighth Avenue, Suite 1H
New York, NY 10018
(646) 256-1007

STATE OF NEW YORK: COUNTY OF NEW YORK

The undersigned, an attorney admitted to practice in the State of New York, under penalties of perjury, affirms the following to be true: Affirmant has read the foregoing Complaint and the contents thereof; the same is true to affirmant's own knowledge, except as to matters therein stated to be alleged on information and belief and as to those matters affirmant believes it to be true; and the reason this verification is made by affirmant and not by the plaintiff is because the plaintiff is not within the county in which your affirmant maintains his principal office. The grounds of affirmant's belief as to all matters not stated upon affirmant's knowledge are communications with the plaintiff, review of records and documents within affirmant's possession.

Affirmed: January 11, 2022

Jason Steinberger
Jason A. Steinberger